SAFETY GUIDE

Keeping babies and children safe at home

A guide. Tap a card to explore, then take the quiz.

Start exploring

Take the quiz



Pick a topic to explore

Take the quiz ›



Choking

Mealtimes and small objects



Safe sleep

Back to sleep, every time



Around the home

Hands on, locks, gates, windows



Water and baths

Drowning and burn risks



Baby gear

Crib, highchair, car seat



Active and protected

Lead, injuries, child protection

Keep small objects out of reach

Menu

At mealtimes

- Hold your baby when you feed them
- Do not prop them up or give strained food in a bottle
- Never leave a small child alone during meals
- Crawling or walking? No spoons, lollipops or Popsicle sticks in the mouth

Babies learn by putting things in their mouth. Keep these away:

- Marbles
- Batteries
- Jewelry
- Magnets
- Nuts and seeds
- Grapes
- Candy
- Ear buds
- Balloons
- Plastic bags
- Coins

Safe sleep for every nap

Menu

Back to sleep

Always place your baby on their back. Never on their side or stomach, which can cause suffocating or choking.

Crib or bassinet

The safest place to sleep. Bed-sharing raises the chance of SUID.

Room-sharing

Baby sleeps in your room in their own sleep space, like a crib. This helps prevent SUID.

Night feeds

Feeding in bed is fine, but read the bed-sharing rules next. When done, put baby back in their own sleep space, on their back.

Tap a card for the full explanation ›

Back to sleep: the basics

Menu

Every sleep

On their back for every nap and every night, until baby turns 1.

Firm and flat

Use a firm, flat sleep surface. Never a sofa, armchair, cushion or soft bed.

Rolling over

Once baby rolls both ways on their own, you do not need to turn them back.

No wedges

Skip sleep positioners, wedges and pillows. Nothing is needed to hold baby in place.

Stay cool

Dress baby in light layers. Do not cover the head or let baby overheat.

Swaddling

Stop swaddling as soon as baby tries to roll. Keep arms free.

Crib and bassinet safety

Menu

Firm mattress

Flat, firm and snug. No gap wider than two fingers between mattress and sides.

Bare is best

Fitted sheet only. No pillows, blankets, bumpers, toys or sheepskin.

Sleep sack

Use a wearable blanket instead of loose covers to keep baby warm.

Weight limit

Follow the bassinet's weight limit. Move to a crib when baby pushes up or rolls.

Safe model

Sturdy base, no drop-side, no broken or missing parts. Spindles under 2⅜ in apart.

Safe spot

Keep the crib or bassinet away from windows, blind cords, lamps and heaters.

Room-sharing, explained

Menu

Same room

Baby sleeps in your room, in their own crib, bassinet or play yard.

6 months+

Do this for at least the first 6 months, ideally up to the first birthday.

Arm's reach

Keep the sleep space beside your bed so you can see and soothe baby.

Own surface

Same room is not same bed. Baby never sleeps on your bed, sofa or chair.

Easier feeds

Night feeds and checks are quicker, so you are less tempted to doze off in bed.

Smoke-free

Keep the home smoke-free. Offer a pacifier at sleep time once breastfeeding is going well.

Bed-sharing safety

Menu

What it means

Bed-sharing is baby sleeping on the same surface as you: a bed, sofa or armchair.

Safest choice

Baby's own sleep space, on their back, right beside your bed.

Higher risk

Highest for babies under 4 months, born early or small, or exposed to smoke.

Never if

You smoke, drank alcohol, took drugs or sleepy medicine, or are very tired.

Never on

A sofa, armchair, waterbed or soft mattress. Remove pillows and heavy covers.

After the feed

Put baby back in their own sleep space, on their back, as soon as you finish.

Hands on, always

Menu

Always keep 1 hand on your baby. Never leave them alone:

- In a vehicle
- During a bath
- In a shopping cart
- With pets or other animals
- On a raised surface: changing table, counter or chair

Never hit or shake your baby. Overwhelmed? Take a break with someone you trust.



Childproof the home

Menu

Lock it up

Safety locks on cabinets with cleaning products or medicine. Keep medicine, cigarettes and lighters out of reach.

Cover outlets

Safety covers on electric outlets that are not in use.

Gate the stairs

Baby gates at the top and bottom of any stairs.

Windows

Screens are not strong enough. Lock windows, open from the top, use guards, and keep furniture away.

Air and smoke

Never smoke around baby. Check smoke and carbon monoxide detectors every month.

Plants and poisons

Check houseplants for poison. If a child eats one, call your local poison center.

Water safety and bath time

Menu

1–2 inches

of water is enough for a baby to drown.

Below 120°F

Water heater setting (48.9°C). Test bath water with your elbow.

At bath time

- Never leave them alone in a bathtub, hot tub or pool
- Use a sink or infant tub with a non-skid mat
- Keep most of the body and all of the face out of the water
- No bath seats: they tip once baby can pull up or stand
- Keep supplies in reach so 1 hand stays on baby

Empty or cover water outside: buckets, trash cans, inflatable pools, recycling bins, coolers with melted ice and large water bowls.

A safe crib

Menu

Fixed sides

Never use drop-side cribs. Babies and toddlers can get trapped.

Under 10°

Do not incline the crib past 10 degrees. An angled mattress is not safe.

Bare crib

No soft bedding, comforters, loose sheets, blankets, pillows, sheepskins, toys or bumpers.

Snug sheet

Use tight-fitting sheets over the crib mattress.

No cords

Keep cords from blinds, lamps or mobiles away from the crib.

2⅜ inches

Maximum gap between spindles, about as wide as a soda can.

Highchair and infant swing

Menu

Highchair

Once baby can sit up without support.

- Keep it away from tables and countertops: baby could push off and tip it
- Make sure the tray latches securely
- Always use the 5-point harness, and never leave baby alone in it

Infant swing

The motion often soothes a baby who cries a lot.

- Always use the 5-point harness
- If baby falls asleep, gently move them to the crib, on their back

Car seat and baby gear

Menu

Car seat

Rear-facing

- In the back seat, until at least 2 years old or the seat's height or weight limit
- Do not let baby sleep in it when not traveling
- As a carrier, set it on a hard, flat floor

Playpen

Sides locked. No pillows, comforters, blankets, bumpers or stuffed animals.

Baby walkers: do not use

Children do not need them to learn to walk, and many babies are hurt in falls.

Baby gates

Block unsafe areas. Place them at the top and bottom of stairs.

Clothes and pacifiers

Menu



Cut the strings

Take strings off sleepers so baby cannot wrap them around the neck or toes.



Check every outfit

Look for loose buttons that could be swallowed, and strings that could wrap around the neck, fingers or toes.



Free pacifier

Do not tie a pacifier to clothes or around the neck.

Active and protected

Menu



Injury prevention: use protective gear for sports, like a helmet.

60 minutes

of age-appropriate physical activity daily, or on most days of the week.

Lead poisoning

Lead is an everyday environmental toxicant that can harm many organ systems. In children, its best-studied effect is cognitive impairment.

Child protection strategies

Menu

- Laws that are enforced
- Norms and values
- Safe environments
- Parent and caregiver support
- Income and economic strengthening
- Response and support services
- Education and life skills
- **No single risk factor predicts abuse**

Reporting: doctors and nurses report a child who appears abused to the DSWD within 48 hours, orally or in writing. Suspected cases also go to the Local Barangay Council for the Protection of Children (BCPC) and the Local Government Unit.

QUICK QUIZ

Test what you learned

4 questions. Tap an answer to see if you got it right. Wrong answer? You can try again.

Start quiz

Menu



Question 1 of 4

Menu

SAFE SLEEP

How should a baby be placed to sleep?

A On their side

B On their back

C On their stomach

Correct!



On their back

Always place baby on their back. Side or stomach sleeping can cause suffocating or choking.

Menu

Next question ›

Not quite



Hint

Think of the position that keeps the airway clear.

Menu

Try again

Question 2 of 4

Menu

WATER SAFETY

How much water can a baby drown in?

A At least one foot of water

B Only a full bathtub

C Just 1 to 2 inches

Correct!



Just 1 to 2 inches

Babies and young children can drown in just 1 to 2 inches of water, so never leave them alone near water.

Menu

Next question ›

Not quite



Hint

It is far less water than you might think.

Menu

Try again

Question 3 of 4

Menu

CAR SEAT

How long should a baby ride in a rear-facing car seat?

A Until at least 2 years old, or the seat’s limit

B Until 6 months

C Until they can walk

Correct!



Until at least 2 years old, or the seat's limit

Babies ride rear-facing in the back seat until at least 2 years old, or the height or weight limit of the seat.

Menu

Next question ›

Not quite



Hint

It is measured in years, not months.

Menu

Try again

Question 4 of 4

Menu

BABY GEAR

Which of these must not be used for babies?

A A rear-facing car seat

B A playpen with locked sides

C A baby walker

Correct!



A baby walker

Baby walkers are very dangerous. Children do not need them to learn to walk, and many babies are hurt in falls.

Menu

Finish ›

Not quite



Hint

One of these is linked to many fall injuries each year.

Menu

Try again

WELL DONE

Safe home, curious child

- Back to sleep, in a crib or bassinet
- One hand on baby, near water and heights
- Small objects, cords and poisons out of reach
- Rear-facing car seat, and no baby walkers

Back to menu

Retake quiz

